



City of Chicago
Richard M. Daley, Mayor

Mayor's Office of
Special Events

Kathy Osterman
Executive Director

City Hall, Room 703
121 North LaSalle Street
Chicago, Illinois 60602
(312) 744-3315
(312) 744-2964 (TDD)
(312) 744-8523 (FAX)

MAYORS CORRESPONDENCE
UNIT 3M-5

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MEMORANDUM

TO: Mayor Daley
FROM: Kathy Osterman *(initials)*
DATE: April 26, 1991
RE: WORLD CUP

While not yet among the biggest sports in the United States, soccer is unquestionably the most popular sport worldwide. It has more than 100 million registered participants, about 15 million of whom are in this country.

Interest in soccer has grown significantly here over the past decade. The number of American high school students playing soccer has doubled; more U.S. universities have soccer than football; it is now the second-largest youth team sport next to basketball. The Chicago Park District currently maintains 69 soccer fields at 51 city locations and the Board of Education has others.

Chicago's primary interest in hosting the 1994 World Cup is based on economic benefits to the city and its people. City planners and World Cup officials estimate that a successful bid to host the Opening Ceremonies and preliminary games would, through tourism, boost our local economy by an estimated \$180 million.

In addition, the worldwide television audience for the World Cup will be quite large. Cumulative viewership of the 1990 games--which means someone watching four games would be counted four times--was 26.6 billion. The estimate for 1994 is projected at 32 billion.

This is an unparalleled opportunity to encourage subsequent tourism by showing the world how beautiful Chicago is as a city. It is inevitable that news and sports coverage will include video of our skyline, our lake and--most important--our people.

We also would arrange all of Chicago's regular City-sponsored events and festivals around a World Cup theme, much as we did on a smaller scale last year with the "All-Star Summer" tie-in to baseball's All-Star Game. Further, our bid proposes a major free



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concert at Petrillo Music Shell the night before the Opening Ceremonies featuring internationally renowned performing artists.

The Opening Ceremonies themselves would be a spectacle similar to the dramatic openings of the Olympic Games.

Chicago's bid is due on May 1, 1991. We are one of 32 cities in the United States bidding on a portion of the games, which will be held over the course of 31 days in as many as 12 cities.

Our bid encompasses the Opening Game, three additional First Round Games, one "Round of 16" Game, one Quarterfinal Game and either one Semifinal Game or the Third- and Fourth-Place Game.

These games would be held at Soldier Field. The Hyatt Regency Chicago has offered to host all World Cup events. Potential training sites include the University of Chicago.

The private sector showed its strong interest in pursuing the World Cup by donating approximately \$250,000 to fund the bid and provide operating expenses for the bidding process [refundable if we are not selected]. Among the contributing companies and agencies are Amoco, the AFL-CIO, the Chicago Board of Trade and the Mercantile Exchange, the Chicago Bulls and Chicago White Sox, Coca-Cola and Pepsi-Cola, Helene Curtis, the Hotel-Motel Association of Illinois, the Illinois Department of Commerce & Community Affairs, McDonald's Restaurants, United Airlines and W.W. Grainger.

We have strong interest as well from regional, state, county and other local governments--all of whom have contributed letters of support to include in our bid package.

On May 23rd, we are sending a delegation to Los Angeles for our oral presentation to the World Cup Bid Committee. As now proposed, this delegation would include the Mayor, Park District President Dick Devine, Jay Pritzker, Lee Stern, CBS/WBBM-TV Anchorman Bill Kurtis and myself as staff coordinator.

Separately, we are bidding on a preparatory World Cup event--The Qualifying Draw--which would be held this December at Arie Crown Theater.